Acknowledge. Thank Mr Legendre for the information. Express the interest which the Dept feels in the results of his labors in the island of Formosa

June 30

DEPARTMENT OF STATE RECEIVED JUN 22 1870

Received   No 109   Mr. J. Smith

Encl Two

U. S. Consulat at Amoy
May 7th 1870.

The Hon: Hamilton Fish
Secretary of State
Washington. D. C.

Sir

I have the honor to hand you under this cover, copy of My No. 53 to the U. S. Chargé d'affairs at Peking, in which is recorded the first practical result of My understanding with the Aborigines of Southern Formosa in october, 1867. Enclosure no1. (no 1)

I have the honor to be
Sir
Your Obedient Servant
Chs. W. LeGendre
U. S. Consul

Copy

No 53.

Consulate of the United States
Amoy May 11th 1870

His Excellency S. W. Williams
U. S. Chargé d'Affairs
Peking

Sir

On the 12th of November, Intelligence was received in Takao that a boat belonging to Mess Millish & Co., of Tamsui, had been wrecked at South Cape, that Mr. Horn, a British subject had been drawned and that two Malays, together with the Chinese crew, were in the hands of the aborigines, who, in accordance with their understanding with Me, had sent to Mr. Pickering to give information of the fact. Three of the Takao community, among them, an Officer of the Imperial Maritime Customs, immediatly visited the spot indicated and were well received by the Chief of the Eighteen Tribes - Tok-e-Tok -. The castaway had been well treated and their freedom was promised upon certain expenses claimed by the Chinese and Hakkas of the border being paid, amounting $200.

The Intendant of Formosa, Lee Tautai, on being requested by Me to send to the Border Hakkas and take delivery of the castaways (Enclosure No 1), at once despatched one officer and Eight Men, and the Mission was successful (Enclosure No 2):

On the 16th of February, the General, Tautai, and Prefect of Formosa, sent Me a joint communication proposing not to built a Fort at Tossupong, but to take other Measures instead (Enclosure No 3)

(Enclosure No. 3). My answer to these officers will, I hope, meet with your approval. (Enclosure No. 4)

In connection with this new plan of settling matters in Southern Formosa, I may be permitted to express the opinion that, if the Imperial Government will allow the Commissioner of Customs to do, in his official capacity and as the agent of the Chinese Government, what, for the last three years, I have done at my individual expense and upon my own responsibility, with the Tribes of Southern Formosa, for the maintainance of good feelings with them; If, at the same time, they promise to faithfully maintain the order of things which, they say, they have inaugurated at the South of the Island (Enclosure No. 4), the erection of a Fort at Tosenpong may be dispensed with. And, if this is done and a special agent must be appointed to act under the orders of the Commissioner at Takao, I hope ~~that~~ the claims of Mr. Pickering's ——, who has done so much for the cause of humanity in Southern Formosa, will not be ignored. (see my despatch to the Hon: Ans. Burlinghame, dated Nov: 7th, 1867, closing paragraph, Dip. Cor. 1868, part 1. page 504, also my despatch to Mr. J. R. Browne, U. S. Minister Peking, dated 31st March 1869).

I have the honor to be
Sir
Your Obedient servant
(Signed) Chas. W. Le Gendre
U. S. Consul

a true copy
Chas W. LeGendre
U.S.C.

Copy

United States Consulate
Taiwanfoo December 12th 1869

General Le Gendre
U. S. Consul
To
Lee, Tautai of Formosa

Sir

Whereas, some years ago, there was an American ship wrecked on the coast of Formosa, at the South Cape, a place under the jurisdiction of the Hung Shang hien, and the sailors, ten in number, all fell into the hands of the savages and were murdered, except one who came to Takao and reported the murder; I then being in Amoy, on hearing of the tragedy, I went to Foochow and saw the Governor General who said that he would order the Tautai + Prefect of Taiwanfoo to examine into the matter and send a weiyuan (Deputy) with a force of soldiers there to establish civil and military officers to the spot, in order that such occurence whether with regard to Chinese or foreign vessel might be avoided for the future. A long time has passed since, and the orders of the Vice Roy have not been completely carried out, so that there is no regularly constituted authority there to act in case of emergency......

One month ago, a Chinese vessel was wrecked at the same place and her crew 24 in number, 22 of whom were Chinese and two foreigners, were all seized by the savages, who were advised by the Hakkas
to

to ask two or three thousand Dollars for their release. The Aborigines, not placing confidence in the Hakkas who, they know have no justice in their dealings, sent for Mr. Pickering who had before acted under similar circumstances without hope of reward, and they have great confidence in him; and he went there and agreed to pay the sum of $200. to be handed over by H. M. Consul on the arrival of the said men in Takao, which sum, I may observe, should be repaid to the Consul, by the several Governments, for whose subjects it was expended. In One American being in the same condition, I have to request you to act as Mr. Cooper has done. Yesterday I heard that, doubtless, owing to no Military and civil Authorities being there, the said captives had not yet arrived at Takao; but I fear they have again been detained by the Hakkas who want $3000. Therefore I beg you will send men and three vessels to the place to make an investigation, which vessels I shall accompany if you so desire as some time back I accompanied the Chentai in order that we may set matters straight.

TRANSLATED BY S M COOK

A true copy
S. M. Cook

Copy

Taiwanfoo January 13th 1870

Lee, Tautai for Formosa, etc, etc, etc.
To
General Le Gendre
U. S. Consul for Amoy
and Formosa,

Sir

I beg to acknowledge the receipt of your communication where by you state that a Chinese craft had been wrecked at Lang Kiu with two foreigners who were detained by the savages, and further you request me to send officers to make an investigation. To this I have already made answer, as the records will show.

Now the officer has returned with the foreigners and in compliance with my order, they have been delivered to Mr. Consul Cooper. I must therefore notify you of what has been done, so that having examined into it, you may cancell the case.

TRANSLATED BY S M COOK

A true copy
S. M. Cook

Copy

Taiwanfoo, February 16th, 1870.

Lee Tautai, Yeung General and
Tsok Prefect for Formosa
To
General Le Gendre
U. S. Consul for Amoy
and Formosa

Sir

We, in this communication, beg to state that, at a place called Lang Kiu, some time since, a vessel called the "Rover" was wrecked and the crew were massacred by the savages. Your Honor has requested to have a Fort built there, at a place called Kwai Pi Shan, in order to protect the Merchants and to keep the savages in check. After I (Tautai) had taken over the duties of my office, you sent me a despatch, stating that a Chinese vessel had been wreck at Lang Kiu and that there were chinese and foreigner on board, all of whom were being detained by the savages. I at once sent a Military officer (Captain) with a staff of soldiers; and on the 12th Month 4th day, this officer recovered and brought back a foreigner named Jani and 16 Chinese, whom I questioned and forwarded to the Prefect ordering the foreigner to be handed over to the Consul (Mr. Cooper) and an answer to that effect has been recorded. Although the Nature of the savages before was cruel, now they are susceptible of being taught better, of which the above circumstance is a proof; and so to keep them in check with force would not be so well as as to show them kindness; a Fort too could only protect a small limit, while the savage territory is very large. As the savages are aware that they must protect foreigners then we ought not to build a Fort to arouse their suspicions. Should there in future be any wrecks any where that the Fort can not command, and the savages secretly commit murders, this would not only be injurious to foreigners but also be very embarrassing to the local Officials; therefore we are now of opinion, that to build a Fort would not be so useful as to station a Township Magistrate, a Lieut: Colonel with 100 Regulars and 8 other commissioned Volunteer officers with 200 Men (2 of which to be stationed at Fung Kong) to guard the place and give up the idea of building the Fort. The savages have submitted to your agreement and we shall send officers there to watch them, so as to show the humanity and benevolence of your great nation's official in not wishing them to be kept in check by force.

TRANSLATED BY S M COOK

A true copy
S M Cook

Copy

Taiwanfoo February 18th 1870

General Le Gendre
U. S. Consul
To
General Yeung, Tautai Lee, and Prefect Teok, officiating for the Island of Formosa.

Sir

I have the honor to acknowledge the receipt of your joint communication of the 17th instant. × × × ×

Since you have appointed a Township Magistrate, a Lieut: Colonel with one hundred regulars and Eight other commissioned Volunteer officers with 200 Men to reside at Kwai Pi Shan and Fung Kang, I am of the Opinion that, pending further instructions from Peking on the subject of the erection of a Fort at the Southern end of the Island, the Measures to be taken immediatly for the Maintainance of order there may be limitted to those which you have already adopted.

TRANSLATED BY S M COOK

A true copy
S M Cook